



Srihari Nataraj's medals at the 2025 Asian Aquatics Championships



50m Backstroke — Silver
200m Freestyle — Silver
4x200m Freestyle Relay — Silver
100m Freestyle — Bronze
100m Backstroke — Bronze
4x100m Freestyle Relay — Bronze
4x100m Medley Relay — Bronze

The guy (Aditya Kariyappa) who set it up was initially working in Eindhoven with the Dutch national team. Two years ago, I took a trip to Eindhoven to get my assessments done. They give you every bit of data — stroke rate, distance per stroke, velocity, stroke length, turn time, underwater distance — to find the most optimal way to swim.

Sometimes, you swim at a high stroke rate, thinking the faster you pull, the faster you'll swim, but that's not true, because sometimes you're just putting in energy to pull faster without catching any water. And if you don't, you're just slipping, wasting energy, and staying in the same place. They have a camera system and delayed feedback. When you swim, you have the whole system with the metrics, and then you get the feedback 30 seconds or a minute later. You can see what's happening with your stroke. Technically, the coach and the analyst are there to tell you what's good and what's not, and you can immediately make changes.

Then, you get metrics to see whether those changes are working positively or negatively. That's something you incorporate into training every day. This is how the Europeans have been training for a long time — and the Australians as well, in some places. Sometimes, textbook-wise, your technique might be right, but you might not actually need it — and until you have the metrics, you don't know.

Any recent example where Swimple helped you?

I went to the Singapore Open earlier this year. It was pretty much my first tournament of the season after the National Games. I wanted to get some races in before the World University Games.

I swam the 100m freestyle heats and felt the stroke rate was a bit conserved. In the evening, I tried pushing a little more, but we realised that more effort for me doesn't mean it's more optimal. I actually swam slower, and we understood why. Going into the

Anchor man: India finished with 13 medals — four silver and nine bronze — and Srihari played a huge role in that success, with four individual medals and three in relays. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

200m freestyle, we kept it optimal. We knew the exact stroke rate I should swim at. Going into the 200m finals, they noticed that in my third turn, I was slowing down going into the wall — I needed to carry more momentum and use that for my underwaters. These small changes made a 0.1–0.2-second difference per lap, which adds up in the end.

Besides swimming, you also love watching films. Did you watch any during the tournament?

Karate Kid Legends before the 200m freestyle finals. I swam the heats and it was bad. I was overthinking a bit when I came back to my room. I told my roommate, and we played it on the TV at the hotel. During the month-long camp, I must've watched at least 15 films.